Olivia's US discovery trip

29 January - 14 February 2027

Five complete family itineraries | Maps + daily navigation | Updated 23 October 2026

Recommendation: start with A. It balances the seven required campus visits, Disney, two full New York days, Boston and the Smithsonian. Choose C instead if a confirmed Medill session and the Northwestern alumni meeting become the highest priority.

This is a detailed planning proposal, not a booking confirmation. Every campus appointment, attraction time, flight seat and accommodation is still subject to availability. All local times are shown in the destination time zone. The date/weekday combination identifies 2027.

Plan - click to open its map	Main consideration	Cost in time / complexity
A - Balanced family + schools	Best overall starting point	7 core guided-campus targets; 2 domestic flights; DC-NYC train. Smithsonian first-Saturday show opportunity. Tight Cornell-Dartmouth connection must be confirmed before bookings.
B - Eastbound road + Case Western	Best if the road journey itself matters	Adds Case Western if Cornell Saturday tours operate. 2 domestic flights plus train; more long winter drives. It does not save a flight versus A because Smithsonian still requires a Boston-DC hop.
C - Friday Medill journalism visit	Best for testing journalism seriously	Places Northwestern on Friday for its usual Medill academic session. Adds a 5-5.5h Michigan-Chicago return drive. 2 domestic flights plus train. Only worth the backtrack if Medill confirms the session.
D - Two contrasting liberal arts colleges	Best for comparing college environments	Adds Williams and Wellesley, with Boston University retained. 3 domestic flights plus train; two NYC stays and a busy final transfer day. No first-Saturday Smithsonian show; choose a daily planetarium show.
E - UC Davis biology + veterinary exploration	Best if animal science is a leading interest	Adds Davis and one domestic flight (3 total). Preserves all must-visits, but changes the preferred direct LA-Chicago leg. Less Chicago leisure and tighter Midwest appointments.

What every option preserves

Hong Kong departure on Day 0; LA arrival; two LA-region leisure days with a full Disneyland day; Northwestern, Notre Dame, Michigan, Cornell, Dartmouth, Boston University and at least one New England liberal arts college; at least two complete NYC days and nights; at least one Boston day; Smithsonian; Hong Kong arrival by Day 16.

Every ordinary night protects at least 10 hours in the hotel. This is time available for rest, not a promise of 10 hours of sleep. Long-haul flight days use the protected in-flight rest you approved. No domestic red-eye flights are assumed.

What I checked, and what remains open

Your signed-in Google Maps account

I opened your saved lists: “Ivy League and Top30 US Schools” (20 places), “Top50 US Schools + Top20 Liberal Arts” (71), “QS 2027 ranked100 or top” (102), and “US Trip” (6). I inspected relevant entries, not every item in the larger lists. The US Trip list supplied Harvard Square, 9/11 Memorial Museum, Empire State Building, Flatiron Building and Charging Bull. Its Inamuragasaki Onsen entry is in Japan and is excluded from this trip. No saved places were changed.

Your college lists include the required Ivy/Midwest schools and several useful liberal arts comparators. List names are your saved categories, not proof of a current ranking. Harvard Square is a saved place but has been removed from the base schedules under your updated rule: Harvard, Yale and MIT require both a confirmed official guided tour and an admissions-officer meeting. No casual campus stop is included at those three.

Transport evidence

I read live Google Maps directions for 21 relevant driving/transit legs. These were “leave now” estimates on 23 October 2026, often at quiet US hours. They are not January/February traffic or snow forecasts. Each route now has a numbered geographic overview, regional Google Maps directions links, and navigation links inside every daily entry. The Midwest Google Maps image was captured live; further Google map-image capture was blocked when Maps reported that it could not reach the internet. Geographic overviews are clearly labelled schematic.

Three corrections that affect the plan

Football: 31 January 2027 is the AFC/NFC conference championship date. Super Bowl LXI is 14 February at SoFi Stadium, when you must already be back in Hong Kong. Watching championship games on TV is possible; LA hosting a game is not assumed. [A8]

SpaceX: the LA-area stop is the Hawthorne facility/Falcon 9 exterior, not the company’s current headquarters, which SpaceX identifies as Starbase, Texas. A short public-sidewalk photo stop is planned; no factory access or company tour is promised. [A7]

Smithsonian: the stars show is astronomy, not astrology. The current planetarium is the Northrop Grumman Planetarium at the National Air and Space Museum in Washington, DC. The New York Hayden Planetarium is a different institution. [A2,A3]

Booking gates before paying for a fixed route

First secure the required university visits, especially Cornell and Dartmouth; then the international flights; then domestic transport, rooms, Disney and Broadway. A/C/E require a late-afternoon Dartmouth appointment after a long drive. B requires a Saturday Cornell tour to keep Case Western. C requires the Friday Medill session. D requires both Williams and Wellesley slots. If these slots do not exist, re-order before purchasing non-refundable transport.

The plan includes no airline inventory check, tour reservation, admission meeting, cabin reservation or message sent to schools/alumni. An official guided visit should be reserved for all core campuses. Self-guided UCLA/NYU walks are explicitly optional extras.

Olivia: evidence-led school exploration

Evidence	What it supports	What it does not establish
G8 final report: Biology 94; Economics 96; Chinese 95; Art 93; Algebra/Geometry 91.	Biology and economics are strong starting interests. Strong maths results mean dislike should not be confused with inability.	A US admissions GPA, likely admission outcome or a fixed career direction.
G8 Chemistry 86; Physics 88; English 85. Chemistry quarterly average 90, final exam 75.	Explore chemistry further and ask how labs, exams and tutoring work. English development matters for writing-heavy study.	That chemistry is unsuitable, or that one examination defines ability.
Earlier G9 snapshot supplied in your October planning: Honors Biology 99, AP Micro/Macro 92, Honors English 90; reading 80 versus writing 95.83 and vocabulary 100.	Promising biology/economics continuation; journalism can test writing interests through science/business stories.	A newly verified G9 transcript or final-year result. This is historical context, not a fresh grade check.

Best questions to test on this trip

Biology / veterinary: Does she enjoy the actual lab work, chemistry and animal-care routines, rather than only the idea of helping animals? Cornell and Davis are the clearest animal-science comparisons; ask for undergraduates' experiences, not access to clinical facilities.

Economics: Does she like explaining incentives and business decisions enough to work through calculus, statistics and econometrics? Undergraduate economics is quantitatively demanding even where computer science is optional.

Journalism: Medill can show how reporting, interviewing, fact-checking and writing differ from competitive speech/debate. Ask about science, health and business reporting and combining journalism with biology/economics. Disliking debate does not rule journalism out.

Biochemistry / pharmaceuticals: BU's Biochemistry & Molecular Biology BA includes substantial biology/chemistry plus maths/physics requirements. It is not a pharmacist qualification. Michigan's BS in Pharmaceutical Sciences is another useful undergraduate comparison; a PharmD is a distinct professional path. [P1-P3]

Veterinary medicine in the US is a professional DVM route after college prerequisites, commonly following a bachelor's degree. Attending Cornell or Davis as an undergraduate does not automatically secure veterinary-school admission. At age 14, the trip should help Olivia compare learning environments rather than label schools as "safe" or "unreachable". [P4,P5]

Sources: June 2026 G8 report card supplied locally; historical G9 evidence from the 5 October 2026 education-planning conversation. The report's "Student Final 3.67" is not converted to a US admissions GPA. Intended entry remains autumn 2030; admissions policies may change.

School shortlist: fit before rank

Ranks below are the 2027 US News edition as reported by College Kickstart, checked against institutional announcements where available. National universities and liberal arts colleges use separate tables. Rankings help orient the visit; they are not an admissions forecast. [R1-R3]

School / category rank	Why compare it for Olivia?	Visit priority
Northwestern - national 9	Medill journalism + possible second major in biology/economics; strong urban access from Evanston. Test writing/reporting interest.	Core in all; C for Friday Medill.
Cornell - national 14	Biology, animal science and pre-vet exploration; contrast college-specific pathways and rural campus life.	Core in all.
Dartmouth - national 12	Undergraduate setting, biology/economics, smaller town and outdoors; alumni connection.	Core in all.
Notre Dame - national 20	Residential campus, environment and community; ask about Catholic identity, everyday student life and fit.	Core in all.
Michigan - national 25	Large public university; biology/economics and pharmaceutical sciences; friend connection offers real-life perspective.	Core in all.
Boston University - national 34	Biochemistry/molecular biology in a city campus; ask how undergraduates reach research and advising.	Core in all; correct name is Boston University.
UC Davis - national 34	Animal science, biology and agriculture/vet ecosystem; strongest reason to add Northern California.	E only; undergraduate tour, not DVM hospital tour.
Case Western - national 44	Life sciences and research-rich Cleveland setting; useful additional public/private comparison.	B optional; sacrificed if Cornell Saturday unavailable.
Amherst - LAC 2	Small college, close faculty contact and flexible exploration of science/economics.	A/C/E; compact stop between Hanover and Boston.
Williams - LAC 1	Small residential college and rural outdoors; useful contrast with city universities.	D; overnight in Williamstown.
Wellesley - LAC 10	Women’s college, science/economics, campus near Boston; ask Olivia how this setting feels.	B/D; easy Boston-area LAC comparison.

Good optional comparators, without another cross-country detour

UCLA (20): Sunday campus exterior walk in LA. NYU (31), Columbia (12) or Barnard (LAC 19): choose at most one NYC admissions add-on, preserving two full city days. Tufts (31): good Boston-area science comparison, but its undergraduate campus and veterinary campus are separate places. Harvard, Yale and MIT are conditional-only: official campus tour AND a confirmed admissions-officer meeting must both be arranged first. Harvard Square and MIT/Kendall campus-adjacent stops have been removed from the base schedules.

I would not add Stanford, Berkeley, Princeton or Penn to the core route merely for rank: they take time from confirmed priorities. Boston College, Northeastern, Bowdoin, Middlebury and Wesleyan are further possible comparators, not additional obligations. [U12]

Harvard, Yale and MIT: your visit condition

Base-route status: all three are excluded. No February 2027 campus tour plus admissions-officer meeting has been confirmed for your family. A student-led walk alone, historic tour, self-guided visit, or admissions-office drop-in does not satisfy your instruction.

School	Verified official offer	Condition before inclusion
Harvard	Official Harvard College visits [U13] Admissions-led visits are distinct from the university visitor center historical tours. Harvard warns that historic-tour guides cannot answer admissions questions.	Reserve the official campus tour and obtain confirmation of a scheduled undergraduate admissions-officer conversation. Do not substitute a commercial Harvard tour.
Yale	Official Yale visits [U14] Current format lists a 1h student tour and a 30min Admissions and Aid session led by an admissions officer.	Both date-specific places must be available. A group information session is not represented here as a private officer meeting; obtain confirmation of the discussion format you want.
MIT	Official MIT visits [U15] MIT offers in-person information sessions and campus tours. The general visit page does not establish a private officer appointment.	Confirm the guided tour and a scheduled opportunity to speak with an undergraduate admissions officer, with the officer role and date stated by MIT.

How they could be added without losing a must-visit

A/C/E: at most one of Harvard or MIT could replace the Boston leisure afternoon on Friday 12 February, if the confirmed programme fits roughly 13:00-16:00 including transfers. BU stays in the morning; airport and rest arrangements stay protected. Never add both automatically.

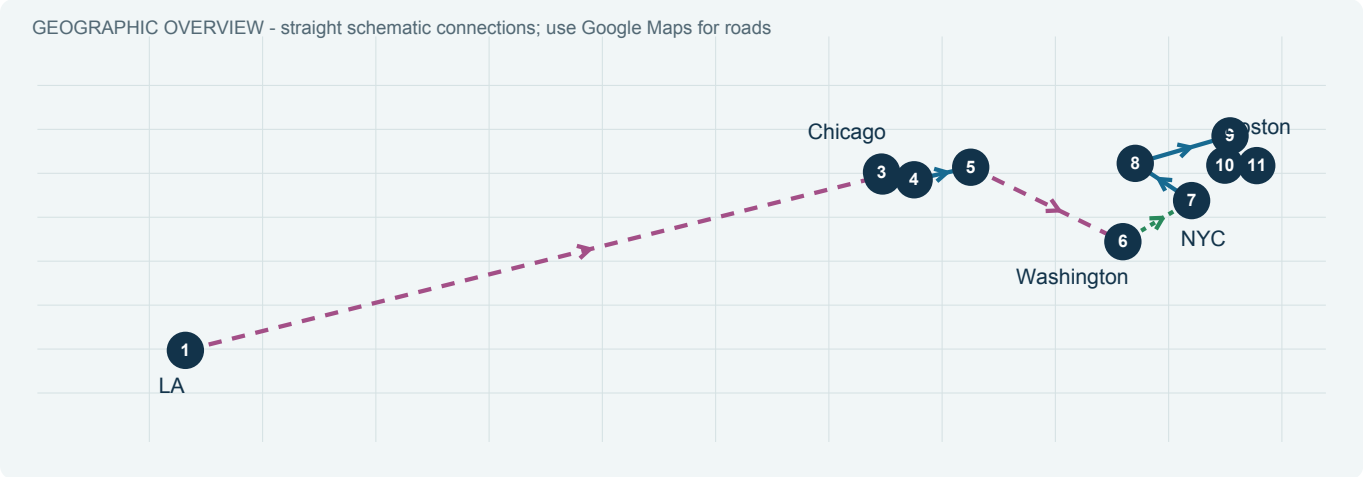
B/D: the Boston day already contains BU and Wellesley. Neither Harvard nor MIT is inserted into that full day. Any addition requires a fresh timing check and a deliberate swap of optional activities; the required liberal arts visit must remain.

Yale: New Haven is outside the currently selected road sequences. It is not an automatic detour. Add it only after the two confirmations and a rechecked transport plan that preserves both full New York days, every required school and daily rest. No Yale route is presented as ready to follow.

No tour bookings or requests to the universities have been made. The report therefore gives a reliable rule for deciding whether to go, rather than treating a published visit programme as a confirmed family appointment.

A | Route map and travel order

Read the numbered stops in order. Click a day in the key to jump to its schedule; click this map to open the Northeast Google Maps route.



Blue solid: road/local transfer. Purple dashed: flight. Green dotted: train. Ground connections on this overview are schematic, not road geometry. Hong Kong departure/return is shown in the schedule. Nearby campuses share the same area at this scale.

Stop	Days	Where to go next	How to get there
1	D0-2	Los Angeles / LAX	Arrive from HKG
2	D3	Chicago / ORD	Fly from previous region
3	D4	Northwestern, Evanston	Drive / local transfer
4	D5	Notre Dame	Drive / local transfer
5	D6	Michigan, Ann Arbor	Drive / local transfer
6	D7-8	Washington / Smithsonian	Fly from previous region
7	D8-10	New York City	Amtrak from Washington
8	D11	Cornell, Ithaca	Drive / local transfer
9	D12	Dartmouth, Hanover	Drive / local transfer
10	D13	Amherst College	Drive / local transfer
11	D13-15	Boston / Boston University	Drive / local transfer

Open Google Maps with stops already entered: LA sightseeing order | Midwest route A | Northeast route A

Washington-NYC train | NYC stars / Broadway / shops

Regional road links cover only the ground portion stated in their title. Use the daily airport links for flights. The daily entries split long city routes into shorter links for easier phone use. Substitute your booked hotel and the tour confirmation meeting point before starting navigation.

A | Balanced family + schools

Best overall starting point · Days 0-8 · Back to route map

LA > Chicago > Notre Dame > Michigan > Washington > NYC > Cornell > Dartmouth > Amherst > Boston.

Day	Activities and transport (local time)	Stay / protected rest
D0 29 Jan Fri	**Hong Kong > Los Angeles** Evening HKG departure. Candidate UA821 22:45 HKG > 19:30 LAX, same date (12h45). Immigration/bags 1.5-2h; car to Anaheim 75-100min. Hotel about 23:00. [F1] **Google Maps:** LAX > Anaheim	Anaheim walkable to Disney. **23:30-09:30**; also protect 10h in flight.
D1 30 Jan Sat	**Disneyland day** 09:30 breakfast. Walk 10-15min to Disneyland Park; 10:30-20:30 full park day. Reserve ticket AND park entry. Dinner in park; return on foot. Hours/show schedule pending. [A1] **Google Maps:** Disney entrance	Anaheim. **22:00-08:00**
D2 31 Jan Sun	**LA: space, campus, coast** 09:00 drive to SpaceX Hawthorne (60-75min); 10:15 exterior photo. UCLA 45-60min away: 11:30-12:30 self-guided walk; Westwood lunch. Drive 30-45min to Santa Monica; 14:00-17:30 coast/shops. Dinner, then 45-75min to LAX hotel. **Google Maps:** LA stops in order	LAX hotel by 19:30. **20:30-06:30**
D3 01 Feb Mon	**LA > Chicago** 07:15 hotel shuttle; airport about 08:00. Target 10:00 LAX > 16:00 ORD (4h flight + 2h time change). Bags and 60-90min transfer to Evanston; dinner locally. Domestic times are target windows, not booked services. **Google Maps:** Departure: LAX | Arrival: ORD > Evanston	Evanston by 18:30. **21:00-07:00**
D4 02 Feb Tue	**Northwestern + Chicago** 09:30-11:30 reserved Northwestern tour/info; 12:00-13:00 alumni chat if arranged. 14:30-16:00 Chicago Millennium Park/shops (45-60min each way) OR easy Evanston lakefront walk. Dinner 18:00. [U1] **Google Maps:** NU > Millennium Park	Evanston. **20:30-06:30**
D5 03 Feb Wed	**Evanston > Notre Dame** 07:00 CENTRAL depart; allow 3h driving plus 1h clock change, arrive 11:00 EASTERN. Lunch. Target 13:00-15:00 admissions visit; 15:30 Basilica/Grotto. Check in 17:00, dinner. [U3] **Google Maps:** Drive to Notre Dame	Morris Inn, Notre Dame. **21:00-07:00**
D6 04 Feb Thu	**Notre Dame > Ann Arbor** 07:30 depart; allow 3.5h road time, arrive 11:00. Lunch. Target 13:00-15:00 Michigan admissions/student tour. 16:00-18:00 friend and family meal. [U4] **Google Maps:** Drive to Michigan	Ann Arbor distinctive hotel. **21:00-07:00**
D7 05 Feb Fri	**Ann Arbor > Washington** 08:30 drive 45-60min to DTW; return car/check in. Target 12:00-13:30 flight to DCA. Hotel about 15:00; 16:00-17:00 National Mall walk. Chinese New Year Eve dinner 18:00. **Google Maps:** Michigan > DTW | Arrival: DCA > Mall	Washington, near Mall/Union Station. **21:00-07:00**
D8 06 Feb Sat	**Smithsonian > New York** 10:00 Air and Space entry; target 10:30 The Sky Tonight (first-Saturday pattern, reconfirm). Lunch and exhibits until 14:30. Union Station 15:45; target train 16:30-20:00 to NYC (3.5h). Hotel about 21:00. [A2] **Google Maps:** Museum > Union Station | Train: DC > NYC	NYC Midtown West. **21:30-07:30**

A | Balanced family + schools

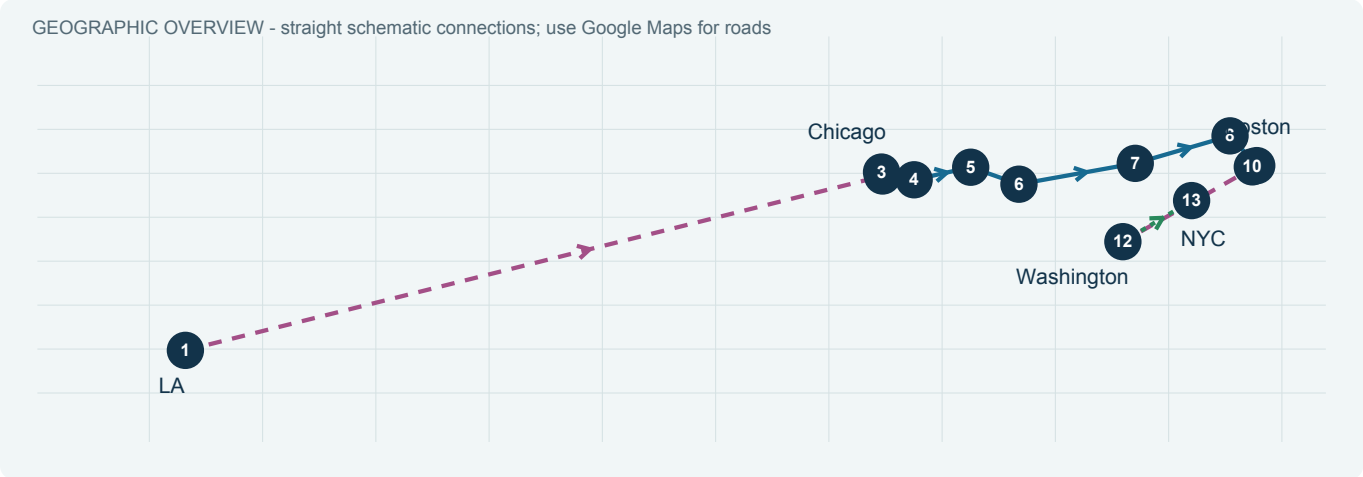
Best overall starting point · Days 9-16 · Back to route map

7 core guided-campus targets; 2 domestic flights; DC-NYC train. Smithsonian first-Saturday show opportunity. Tight Cornell-Dartmouth connection must be confirmed before bookings.

Day	Activities and transport (local time)	Stay / protected rest
D9 07 Feb Sun	**NYC full day 1: stars + stage** 10:00-12:00 AMNH / Hayden space show, ticket permitting. Lunch. Target Wicked matinee 14:00-16:45. Rockefeller Center, FAO/Jellycat and Nintendo 17:00-18:30; dinner 19:00. Walk/subway, 15-40min legs. [A3-A5] **Google Maps:** AMNH > Wicked | Wicked > FAO > Nintendo	NYC, second full sightseeing day follows. **21:30-07:30**
D10 08 Feb Mon	**NYC full day 2: city life** 09:30 Greenwich Village/NYU (official tour only if reserved); SoHo 11:00, Chinatown lunch 12:30. Wall Street/Bull 14:00; 9/11 Memorial 15:15; Flatiron 17:00; Empire State 18:00, dinner 19:00. Subway/walk 15-35min legs. **Google Maps:** Village > SoHo > Chinatown | Bull > memorial > Flatiron > Empire	NYC, third night. **20:30-06:30**
D11 09 Feb Tue	**NYC > Cornell** 07:00 car collection; depart 07:30. Allow 5.5h including breaks, arrive Ithaca 13:00. Lunch/parking. Target 14:00-16:00 Cornell registered tour/info. Cottage check-in about 17:00; dinner 18:00. [U5] **Google Maps:** Drive NYC > Cornell	Ithaca: New Park cottage candidate. **20:30-06:30**
D12 10 Feb Wed	**Cornell > Dartmouth** 07:00 depart; allow 6.5h including breaks, arrive Hanover 13:30. Target 14:15 check-in, 14:30-16:15 Dartmouth info/tour; alumni chat 16:30 if arranged. Packed lunch on road. This is the tightest tour/drive connection. [U6] **Google Maps:** Drive Cornell > Dartmouth	Hanover Inn. **21:00-07:00**
D13 11 Feb Thu	**Dartmouth > Amherst > Boston** 08:30 depart; drive 2h15 to Amherst. Target 11:30-13:30 registered Amherst visit. Lunch; 14:30 drive 2.5h to Boston. Return car, dinner 18:00. [U7] **Google Maps:** Dartmouth > Amherst > BU	Boston Back Bay. **21:00-07:00**
D14 12 Feb Fri	**Boston full day > airport** 09:30-11:30 Boston University tour/info. Chinatown lunch 12:30; Public Garden 14:00-15:00; Newbury Street shops 15:15-16:15. Hotel 17:00-20:00 for meal, packing and rest (keep room/day-use). Taxi 20:45; BOS 21:30. Harvard/MIT excluded unless both required appointments are confirmed. [U2] **Google Maps:** BU > Chinatown > Public Garden | Public Garden > Newbury > BOS	No hotel overnight: flight just after midnight. Protected 10h rest on long-haul flight.
D15 13 Feb Sat	**Boston > Hong Kong** Candidate CX811 departs BOS 00:30 SATURDAY 13 Feb; flight about 15h30. Arrive Hong Kong SUNDAY 14 Feb. Protect a 10h in-flight rest block after initial meal. [F2] **Google Maps:** BOS terminal location	In flight; **10h protected rest**.
D16 14 Feb Sun	**Home in Hong Kong** Candidate CX811 arrives 05:00 HKT, Sunday 14 Feb. Transfer home and leave the day unscheduled for sleep/recovery. Arrival meets Day 16 deadline. [F2] **Google Maps:** Hong Kong arrival	Hong Kong home; recovery day.

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7	D7-8	Cornell, Ithaca	Drive / local transfer
8	D9-10	Dartmouth, Hanover	Drive / local transfer
9	D10-12	Boston / Boston University	Drive / local transfer
10	D11	Wellesley College	Drive / local transfer
11	D11-12	Boston / Boston University	Drive / local transfer
12	D12	Washington / Smithsonian	Fly from previous region
13	D12-15	New York City	Amtrak from Washington

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D6 04 Feb Thu	**Michigan > Cleveland** 07:00 leave Notre Dame; 3.5h drive to Ann Arbor. Target Michigan visit 11:00-13:00; friend/lunch 13:00-14:00. Drive 15:00-18:30 to Cleveland (3.5h with break). Dinner at hotel. [U4] **Google Maps:** Notre Dame > Michigan > Case	Cleveland University Circle. **21:00-07:00**
D7 05 Feb Fri	**Case Western > Ithaca** 09:00-11:00 optional Case Western visit. 12:00 depart, allow 6.5h with breaks to Ithaca. Dinner/check-in 18:30-19:30. If Saturday Cornell tour unavailable, DROP Case and drive 07:00-13:30 for Friday Cornell tour instead. [U10] **Google Maps:** Drive Case > Cornell	Ithaca cottage/inn. **21:00-07:00**
D8 06 Feb Sat	**Cornell + cottage afternoon** Target 10:00-12:00 Cornell guided visit (Saturday slot must exist). Lunch; 13:00-15:00 safe maintained lakeside paths or indoor campus activity; cottage evening. If Cornell visited Friday, today becomes a genuine weather/rest buffer. [U5] **Google Maps:** Cornell campus | Cottage candidate	Ithaca second night. **21:00-07:00**

B | Eastbound road + Case Western

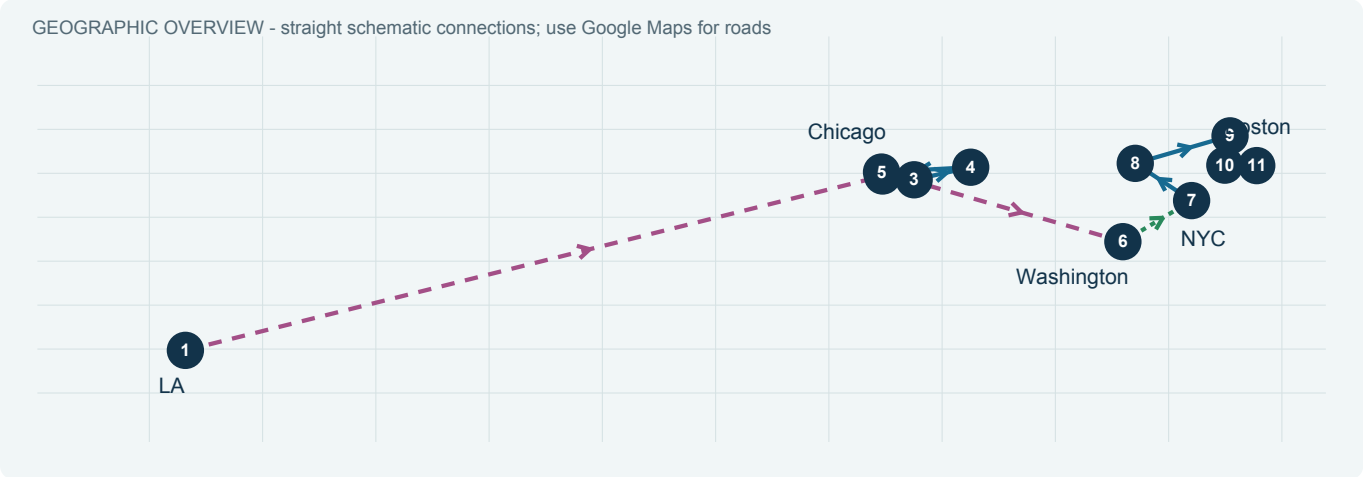
Best if the road journey itself matters · Days 9-16 · Back to route map

Adds Case Western if Cornell Saturday tours operate. 2 domestic flights plus train; more long winter drives. It does not save a flight versus A because Smithsonian still requires a Boston-DC hop.

Day	Activities and transport (local time)	Stay / protected rest
D9 07 Feb Sun	**Ithaca > Hanover** 09:00 depart for Hanover; allow 6.5h road time with warm lunch and breaks. Arrive 15:30; short town walk, early dinner. No campus appointment tied to the drive today. **Google Maps:** Drive Ithaca > Hanover	Hanover Inn. **21:00-07:00**
D10 08 Feb Mon	**Dartmouth > Boston** Target Dartmouth info/tour 11:00-13:00; alumni chat over lunch if arranged. Drive 14:00-17:00 to Boston, return rental. Dinner and easy Back Bay walk. [U6] **Google Maps:** Drive Dartmouth > Boston	Boston. **21:00-07:00**
D11 09 Feb Tue	**BU + Wellesley** 09:30-11:30 Boston University guided visit. Lunch; car/taxi 45-60min to Wellesley. Target 14:00-15:45 counselor session + student tour. Return 45-60min; Chinatown dinner 17:30-18:30. Harvard/MIT excluded unless both required appointments are confirmed. [U2,U9] **Google Maps:** BU > Wellesley > Chinatown	Boston. **20:00-06:00**
D12 10 Feb Wed	**Boston > Smithsonian > NYC** 06:00 taxi; BOS 06:30. Target flight 08:30-10:15 to DCA. Smithsonian Air and Space 11:30-15:30, including a paid planetarium show. Train target 17:00-20:30 Washington > NYC. Hotel about 21:30. [A2] **Google Maps:** Departure BOS / arrival DCA | DCA > Smithsonian > Union | Train DC > NYC	NYC. **22:00-08:00**
D13 11 Feb Thu	**NYC full day 1: stage** 10:00-12:00 AMNH/space show. Lunch and Rockefeller/FAO/Jellycat/Nintendo 14:00-17:00. Early dinner. Target Wicked 19:00-21:45; stay near theater, hotel about 22:00. Walk/subway 15-40min legs. [A3-A5] **Google Maps:** AMNH > FAO > Nintendo | Wicked theater	NYC. **22:30-08:30**
D14 12 Feb Fri	**NYC full day 2: downtown** 09:30 Greenwich Village; SoHo 11:00; Chinatown lunch. 14:00 Wall Street/Bull, 15:15 9/11 Memorial, 17:00 Flatiron, 18:00 Empire State. Dinner and packing by 20:00. Walk/subway 15-35min legs. **Google Maps:** Village > SoHo > Chinatown | Bull > memorial > Flatiron > Empire	NYC. **21:00-08:00**
D15 13 Feb Sat	**New York > Hong Kong** 09:00 hotel departure; allow 90min to JFK and arrive 10:30. Candidate CX831 13:40 JFK > Hong Kong (16h15). Protect 10h in-flight rest; arrival next date. [F3] **Google Maps:** Midtown > JFK	In flight; **10h protected rest**.
D16 14 Feb Sun	**Home in Hong Kong** Candidate CX831 arrives 18:55 HKT on Sunday 14 Feb. Transfer home and sleep. Meets deadline but has less disruption margin than the Boston return. [F3] **Google Maps:** Hong Kong arrival	Hong Kong home.

C | Route map and travel order

Read the numbered stops in order. Click a day in the key to jump to its schedule; click this map to open the Northeast Google Maps route.



Blue solid: road/local transfer. Purple dashed: flight. Green dotted: train. Ground connections on this overview are schematic, not road geometry. Hong Kong departure/return is shown in the schedule. Nearby campuses share the same area at this scale.

Stop	Days	Where to go next	How to get there
1	D0-2	Los Angeles / LAX	Arrive from HKG
2	D3	Chicago / ORD	Fly from previous region
3	D4	Notre Dame	Drive / local transfer
4	D5	Michigan, Ann Arbor	Drive / local transfer
5	D6-7	Northwestern, Evanston	Drive / local transfer
6	D7-8	Washington / Smithsonian	Fly from previous region
7	D8-10	New York City	Amtrak from Washington
8	D11	Cornell, Ithaca	Drive / local transfer
9	D12	Dartmouth, Hanover	Drive / local transfer
10	D13	Amherst College	Drive / local transfer
11	D13-15	Boston / Boston University	Drive / local transfer

Open Google Maps with stops already entered: LA sightseeing order | Midwest route C | Northeast route C

Washington-NYC train | NYC stars / Broadway / shops

Regional road links cover only the ground portion stated in their title. Use the daily airport links for flights. The daily entries split long city routes into shorter links for easier phone use. Substitute your booked hotel and the tour confirmation meeting point before starting navigation.

C | Friday Medill journalism visit

Best for testing journalism seriously · Days 0-8 · Back to route map

LA > Chicago > Notre Dame > Michigan > Chicago/Northwestern > Washington > NYC > Cornell > Dartmouth > Amherst > Boston.

Day	Activities and transport (local time)	Stay / protected rest
D0 29 Jan Fri	**Hong Kong > Los Angeles** Evening HKG departure. Candidate UA821 22:45 HKG > 19:30 LAX, same date (12h45). Immigration/bags 1.5-2h; car to Anaheim 75-100min. Hotel about 23:00. [F1] **Google Maps:** LAX > Anaheim	Anaheim walkable to Disney. **23:30-09:30**; also protect 10h in flight.
D1 30 Jan Sat	**Disneyland day** 09:30 breakfast. Walk 10-15min to Disneyland Park; 10:30-20:30 full park day. Reserve ticket AND park entry. Dinner in park; return on foot. Hours/show schedule pending. [A1] **Google Maps:** Disney entrance	Anaheim. **22:00-08:00**
D2 31 Jan Sun	**LA: space, campus, coast** 09:00 drive to SpaceX Hawthorne (60-75min); 10:15 exterior photo. UCLA 45-60min away: 11:30-12:30 self-guided walk; Westwood lunch. Drive 30-45min to Santa Monica; 14:00-17:30 coast/shops. Dinner, then 45-75min to LAX hotel. **Google Maps:** LA stops in order	LAX hotel by 19:30. **20:30-06:30**
D3 01 Feb Mon	**LA > Chicago** 07:15 hotel shuttle; airport about 08:00. Target 10:00 LAX > 16:00 ORD (4h flight + 2h time change). Bags and 60-90min transfer to Evanston; dinner locally. Domestic times are target windows, not booked services. **Google Maps:** Departure: LAX | Arrival: ORD > Evanston	Evanston by 18:30. **21:00-07:00**
D4 02 Feb Tue	**Chicago > Notre Dame** 07:00 CENTRAL departure; 3h road time + 1h clock change, arrive 11:00 EASTERN. Lunch; target admissions visit 13:00-15:00. Basilica/Grotto 15:30, dinner and check-in. [U3] **Google Maps:** Drive to Notre Dame	Morris Inn. **21:00-07:00**
D5 03 Feb Wed	**Notre Dame > Michigan** 07:30 depart; drive 3.5h to Ann Arbor. Lunch. Target 13:00-15:00 Michigan admissions/student tour; friend visit and dinner 16:00-18:00. [U4] **Google Maps:** Drive to Michigan	Ann Arbor. **21:00-07:00**
D6 04 Feb Thu	**Ann Arbor > Evanston** 09:00 EASTERN depart; allow 5.5h road time, arrive 13:30 CENTRAL (gain 1h). Check in/lunch. 15:00-17:00 Evanston or Chicago highlights, keeping evening easy before Medill day. **Google Maps:** Drive Michigan > Northwestern	Evanston. **21:00-07:00**
D7 05 Feb Fri	**Northwestern + Medill > DC** Target NU general/media tour 09:30-11:00; alumni/lunch 11:30. Medill academic session target 13:00-14:00 (usual Friday pattern). Transfer 14:30-16:00 ORD; target 18:00-21:00 EASTERN flight to DCA. Hotel about 22:00. [U1] **Google Maps:** NU > Medill > ORD | Arrival DCA	Washington. **22:30-08:30**
D8 06 Feb Sat	**Smithsonian > New York** 10:00 Air and Space entry; target 10:30 The Sky Tonight (first-Saturday pattern, reconfirm). Lunch and exhibits until 14:30. Union Station 15:45; target train 16:30-20:00 to NYC (3.5h). Hotel about 21:00. [A2] **Google Maps:** Museum > Union Station | Train: DC > NYC	NYC Midtown West. **21:30-07:30**

C | Friday Medill journalism visit

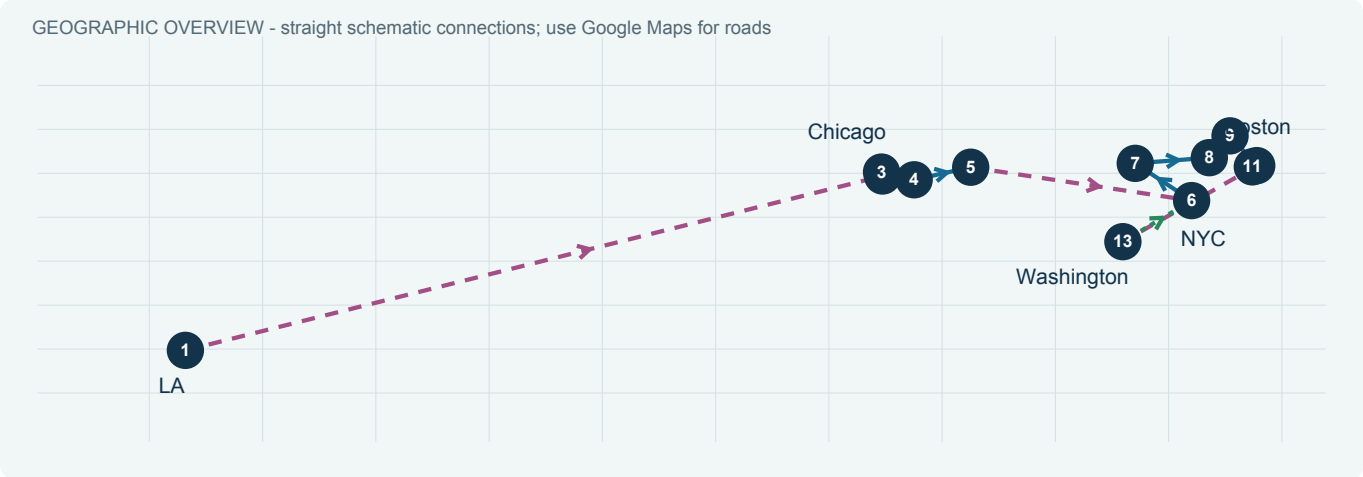
Best for testing journalism seriously · Days 9-16 · Back to route map

Places Northwestern on Friday for its usual Medill academic session. Adds a 5-5.5h Michigan-Chicago return drive. 2 domestic flights plus train. Only worth the backtrack if Medill confirms the session.

Day	Activities and transport (local time)	Stay / protected rest
D9 07 Feb Sun	**NYC full day 1: stars + stage** 10:00-12:00 AMNH / Hayden space show, ticket permitting. Lunch. Target Wicked matinee 14:00-16:45. Rockefeller Center, FAO/Jellycat and Nintendo 17:00-18:30; dinner 19:00. Walk/subway, 15-40min legs. [A3-A5] **Google Maps:** AMNH > Wicked | Wicked > FAO > Nintendo	NYC, second full sightseeing day follows. **21:30-07:30**
D10 08 Feb Mon	**NYC full day 2: city life** 09:30 Greenwich Village/NYU (official tour only if reserved); SoHo 11:00, Chinatown lunch 12:30. Wall Street/Bull 14:00; 9/11 Memorial 15:15; Flatiron 17:00; Empire State 18:00, dinner 19:00. Subway/walk 15-35min legs. **Google Maps:** Village > SoHo > Chinatown | Bull > memorial > Flatiron > Empire	NYC, third night. **20:30-06:30**
D11 09 Feb Tue	**NYC > Cornell** 07:00 car collection; depart 07:30. Allow 5.5h including breaks, arrive Ithaca 13:00. Lunch/parking. Target 14:00-16:00 Cornell registered tour/info. Cottage check-in about 17:00; dinner 18:00. [U5] **Google Maps:** Drive NYC > Cornell	Ithaca: New Park cottage candidate. **20:30-06:30**
D12 10 Feb Wed	**Cornell > Dartmouth** 07:00 depart; allow 6.5h including breaks, arrive Hanover 13:30. Target 14:15 check-in, 14:30-16:15 Dartmouth info/tour; alumni chat 16:30 if arranged. Packed lunch on road. This is the tightest tour/drive connection. [U6] **Google Maps:** Drive Cornell > Dartmouth	Hanover Inn. **21:00-07:00**
D13 11 Feb Thu	**Dartmouth > Amherst > Boston** 08:30 depart; drive 2h15 to Amherst. Target 11:30-13:30 registered Amherst visit. Lunch; 14:30 drive 2.5h to Boston. Return car, dinner 18:00. [U7] **Google Maps:** Dartmouth > Amherst > BU	Boston Back Bay. **21:00-07:00**
D14 12 Feb Fri	**Boston full day > airport** 09:30-11:30 Boston University tour/info. Chinatown lunch 12:30; Public Garden 14:00-15:00; Newbury Street shops 15:15-16:15. Hotel 17:00-20:00 for meal, packing and rest (keep room/day-use). Taxi 20:45; BOS 21:30. Harvard/MIT excluded unless both required appointments are confirmed. [U2] **Google Maps:** BU > Chinatown > Public Garden | Public Garden > Newbury > BOS	No hotel overnight: flight just after midnight. Protected 10h rest on long-haul flight.
D15 13 Feb Sat	**Boston > Hong Kong** Candidate CX811 departs BOS 00:30 SATURDAY 13 Feb; flight about 15h30. Arrive Hong Kong SUNDAY 14 Feb. Protect a 10h in-flight rest block after initial meal. [F2] **Google Maps:** BOS terminal location	In flight; **10h protected rest**.
D16 14 Feb Sun	**Home in Hong Kong** Candidate CX811 arrives 05:00 HKT, Sunday 14 Feb. Transfer home and leave the day unscheduled for sleep/recovery. Arrival meets Day 16 deadline. [F2] **Google Maps:** Hong Kong arrival	Hong Kong home; recovery day.

D | Route map and travel order

Read the numbered stops in order. Click a day in the key to jump to its schedule; click this map to open the Northeast Google Maps route.



Blue solid: road/local transfer. Purple dashed: flight. Green dotted: train. Ground connections on this overview are schematic, not road geometry. Hong Kong departure/return is shown in the schedule. Nearby campuses share the same area at this scale.

Stop	Days	Where to go next	How to get there
1	D0-2	Los Angeles / LAX	Arrive from HKG
2	D3	Chicago / ORD	Fly from previous region
3	D4	Northwestern, Evanston	Drive / local transfer
4	D5	Notre Dame	Drive / local transfer
5	D6	Michigan, Ann Arbor	Drive / local transfer
6	D7-9	New York City	Fly from previous region
7	D10	Cornell, Ithaca	Drive / local transfer
8	D11	Williams, Williamstown	Drive / local transfer
9	D12	Dartmouth, Hanover	Drive / local transfer
10	D12-14	Boston / Boston University	Drive / local transfer
11	D13	Wellesley College	Drive / local transfer
12	D13-14	Boston / Boston University	Drive / local transfer
13	D14	Washington / Smithsonian	Fly from previous region
14	D14-15	New York City	Amtrak from Washington

Open Google Maps with stops already entered: LA sightseeing order | Midwest route D | Northeast route D

Washington-NYC train | NYC stars / Broadway / shops

Regional road links cover only the ground portion stated in their title. Use the daily airport links for flights. The daily entries split long city routes into shorter links for easier phone use. Substitute your booked hotel and the tour confirmation meeting point before starting navigation.

D | Two contrasting liberal arts colleges

Best for comparing college environments · Days 0-8 · Back to route map

LA > Chicago > Notre Dame > Michigan > NYC > Cornell > Williams > Dartmouth > Boston/Wellesley > Washington > NYC.

Day	Activities and transport (local time)	Stay / protected rest
D0 29 Jan Fri	**Hong Kong > Los Angeles** Evening HKG departure. Candidate UA821 22:45 HKG > 19:30 LAX, same date (12h45). Immigration/bags 1.5-2h; car to Anaheim 75-100min. Hotel about 23:00. [F1] **Google Maps:** LAX > Anaheim	Anaheim walkable to Disney. **23:30-09:30**; also protect 10h in flight.
D1 30 Jan Sat	**Disneyland day** 09:30 breakfast. Walk 10-15min to Disneyland Park; 10:30-20:30 full park day. Reserve ticket AND park entry. Dinner in park; return on foot. Hours/show schedule pending. [A1] **Google Maps:** Disney entrance	Anaheim. **22:00-08:00**
D2 31 Jan Sun	**LA: space, campus, coast** 09:00 drive to SpaceX Hawthorne (60-75min); 10:15 exterior photo. UCLA 45-60min away: 11:30-12:30 self-guided walk; Westwood lunch. Drive 30-45min to Santa Monica; 14:00-17:30 coast/shops. Dinner, then 45-75min to LAX hotel. **Google Maps:** LA stops in order	LAX hotel by 19:30. **20:30-06:30**
D3 01 Feb Mon	**LA > Chicago** 07:15 hotel shuttle; airport about 08:00. Target 10:00 LAX > 16:00 ORD (4h flight + 2h time change). Bags and 60-90min transfer to Evanston; dinner locally. Domestic times are target windows, not booked services. **Google Maps:** Departure: LAX | Arrival: ORD > Evanston	Evanston by 18:30. **21:00-07:00**
D4 02 Feb Tue	**Northwestern + Chicago** 09:30-11:30 reserved Northwestern tour/info; 12:00-13:00 alumni chat if arranged. 14:30-16:00 Chicago Millennium Park/shops (45-60min each way) OR easy Evanston lakefront walk. Dinner 18:00. [U1] **Google Maps:** NU > Millennium Park	Evanston. **20:30-06:30**
D5 03 Feb Wed	**Evanston > Notre Dame** 07:00 CENTRAL depart; allow 3h driving plus 1h clock change, arrive 11:00 EASTERN. Lunch. Target 13:00-15:00 admissions visit; 15:30 Basilica/Grotto. Check in 17:00, dinner. [U3] **Google Maps:** Drive to Notre Dame	Morris Inn, Notre Dame. **21:00-07:00**
D6 04 Feb Thu	**Notre Dame > Ann Arbor** 07:30 depart; allow 3.5h road time, arrive 11:00. Lunch. Target 13:00-15:00 Michigan admissions/student tour. 16:00-18:00 friend and family meal. [U4] **Google Maps:** Drive to Michigan	Ann Arbor distinctive hotel. **21:00-07:00**
D7 05 Feb Fri	**Michigan > New York** 08:30 drive 45-60min to DTW; return car. Target flight 12:00-14:00 to NYC, transfer 60-90min to Midtown. Hotel about 16:00. Chinese New Year Eve dinner 18:00. **Google Maps:** Michigan > DTW | Arrival NYC base	NYC. **21:00-07:00**
D8 06 Feb Sat	**NYC full day 1: downtown** 09:30 Greenwich Village/NYU (official tour only if reserved); SoHo 11:00, Chinatown lunch 12:30. Wall Street/Bull 14:00; 9/11 Memorial 15:15; Flatiron 17:00; Empire State 18:00, dinner 19:00. Subway/walk 15-35min legs. **Google Maps:** Village > SoHo > Chinatown | Bull > memorial > Flatiron > Empire	NYC. **21:00-07:00**

D | Two contrasting liberal arts colleges

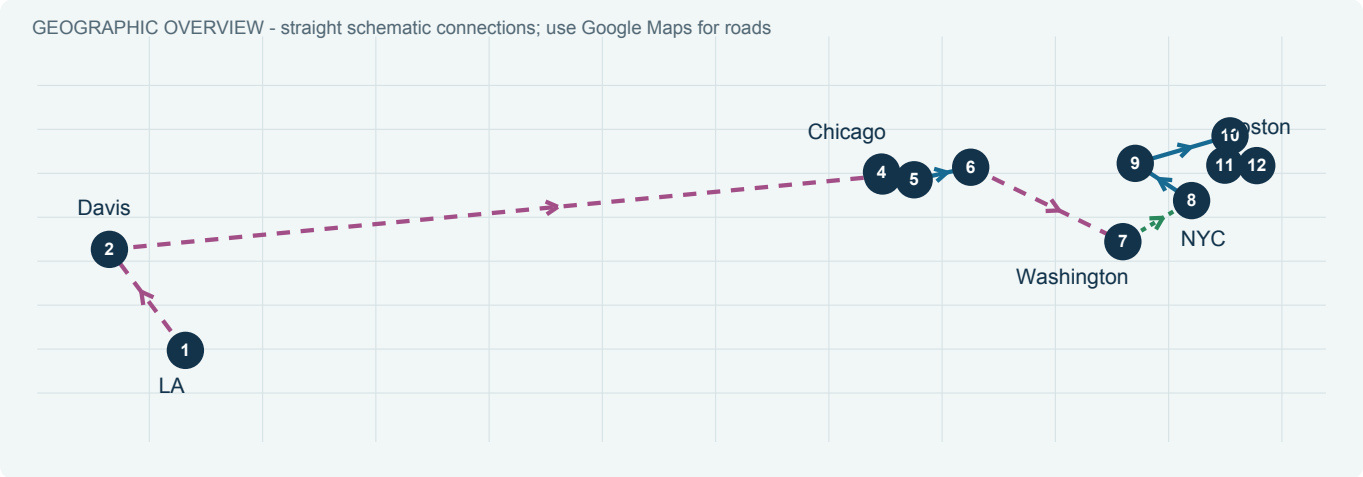
Best for comparing college environments · Days 9-16 · Back to route map

Adds Williams and Wellesley, with Boston University retained. 3 domestic flights plus train; two NYC stays and a busy final transfer day. No first-Saturday Smithsonian show; choose a daily planetarium show.

Day	Activities and transport (local time)	Stay / protected rest
D9 07 Feb Sun	**NYC full day 2: stars + stage** 10:00-12:00 AMNH / Hayden space show, ticket permitting. Lunch. Target Wicked matinee 14:00-16:45. Rockefeller Center, FAO/Jellycat and Nintendo 17:00-18:30; dinner 19:00. Walk/subway, 15-40min legs. [A3-A5] **Google Maps:** AMNH > Wicked | Wicked > FAO > Nintendo	NYC. **20:30-06:30**
D10 08 Feb Mon	**NYC > Cornell** 07:00 car collection; depart 07:30. Allow 5.5h including breaks, arrive Ithaca 13:00. Lunch/parking. Target 14:00-16:00 Cornell registered tour/info. Cottage check-in about 17:00; dinner 18:00. [U5] **Google Maps:** Drive NYC > Cornell	Ithaca: New Park cottage candidate. **20:30-06:30**
D11 09 Feb Tue	**Cornell > Williams** 07:30 depart Ithaca; allow 4.5-5h to Williamstown. Lunch. Target Williams 13:30-15:30 student tour + admission session. Town/inn 16:00, early dinner. [U8] **Google Maps:** Drive Cornell > Williams	The Williams Inn. **21:00-07:00**
D12 10 Feb Wed	**Williams > Dartmouth > Boston** 07:30 depart; 2h45 road time to Hanover. Target Dartmouth 11:00-13:00 info/tour; alumni/lunch. Drive 14:00-17:00 to Boston and return car. Dinner. [U6] **Google Maps:** Williams > Dartmouth > Boston	Boston. **21:00-07:00**
D13 11 Feb Thu	**BU + Wellesley** 09:30-11:30 Boston University guided visit. Lunch; car/taxi 45-60min to Wellesley. Target 14:00-15:45 counselor session + student tour. Return 45-60min; Chinatown dinner 17:30-18:30. Harvard/MIT excluded unless both required appointments are confirmed. [U2,U9] **Google Maps:** BU > Wellesley > Chinatown	Boston. **20:00-06:00**
D14 12 Feb Fri	**Boston > Smithsonian > NYC** 06:00 taxi; BOS 06:30. Target flight 08:30-10:15 to DCA. Smithsonian Air and Space 11:30-15:30, including a paid planetarium show. Train target 17:00-20:30 Washington > NYC. Hotel about 21:30. [A2] **Google Maps:** Departure BOS / arrival DCA | DCA > Smithsonian > Union | Train DC > NYC	NYC. **22:00-08:00**
D15 13 Feb Sat	**New York > Hong Kong** 09:00 hotel departure; allow 90min to JFK and arrive 10:30. Candidate CX831 13:40 JFK > Hong Kong (16h15). Protect 10h in-flight rest; arrival next date. [F3] **Google Maps:** Midtown > JFK	In flight; **10h protected rest**.
D16 14 Feb Sun	**Home in Hong Kong** Candidate CX831 arrives 18:55 HKT on Sunday 14 Feb. Transfer home and sleep. Meets deadline but has less disruption margin than the Boston return. [F3] **Google Maps:** Hong Kong arrival	Hong Kong home.

E | Route map and travel order

Read the numbered stops in order. Click a day in the key to jump to its schedule; click this map to open the Northeast Google Maps route.



Blue solid: road/local transfer. Purple dashed: flight. Green dotted: train. Ground connections on this overview are schematic, not road geometry. Hong Kong departure/return is shown in the schedule. Nearby campuses share the same area at this scale.

Stop	Days	Where to go next	How to get there
1	D0-2	Los Angeles / LAX	Arrive from HKG
2	D3-4	UC Davis	Fly from previous region
3	D4	Chicago / ORD	Fly from previous region
4	D5	Northwestern, Evanston	Drive / local transfer
5	D5-6	Notre Dame	Drive / local transfer
6	D6-7	Michigan, Ann Arbor	Drive / local transfer
7	D7-8	Washington / Smithsonian	Fly from previous region
8	D8-10	New York City	Amtrak from Washington
9	D11	Cornell, Ithaca	Drive / local transfer
10	D12	Dartmouth, Hanover	Drive / local transfer
11	D13	Amherst College	Drive / local transfer
12	D13-15	Boston / Boston University	Drive / local transfer

Open Google Maps with stops already entered: LA sightseeing order | Midwest route E | Northeast route E

Washington-NYC train | NYC stars / Broadway / shops | SMF-UC Davis

Regional road links cover only the ground portion stated in their title. Use the daily airport links for flights. The daily entries split long city routes into shorter links for easier phone use. Substitute your booked hotel and the tour confirmation meeting point before starting navigation.

E | UC Davis biology + veterinary exploration

Best if animal science is a leading interest · Days 0-8 · Back to route map

LA > Sacramento/UC Davis > Chicago > Northwestern > Notre Dame > Michigan > Washington > NYC > Cornell > Dartmouth > Amherst > Boston.

Day	Activities and transport (local time)	Stay / protected rest
D0 29 Jan Fri	**Hong Kong > Los Angeles** Evening HKG departure. Candidate UA821 22:45 HKG > 19:30 LAX, same date (12h45). Immigration/bags 1.5-2h; car to Anaheim 75-100min. Hotel about 23:00. [F1] **Google Maps:** LAX > Anaheim	Anaheim walkable to Disney. **23:30-09:30**; also protect 10h in flight.
D1 30 Jan Sat	**Disneyland day** 09:30 breakfast. Walk 10-15min to Disneyland Park; 10:30-20:30 full park day. Reserve ticket AND park entry. Dinner in park; return on foot. Hours/show schedule pending. [A1] **Google Maps:** Disney entrance	Anaheim. **22:00-08:00**
D2 31 Jan Sun	**LA: space, campus, coast** 09:00 drive to SpaceX Hawthorne (60-75min); 10:15 exterior photo. UCLA 45-60min away: 11:30-12:30 self-guided walk; Westwood lunch. Drive 30-45min to Santa Monica; 14:00-17:30 coast/shops. Dinner, then 45-75min to LAX hotel. **Google Maps:** LA stops in order	LAX hotel by 19:30. **20:30-06:30**
D3 01 Feb Mon	**LA > Sacramento > UC Davis** 07:15 LAX shuttle; target flight 10:00-11:30 to SMF. Bags/rental then 45-60min to Davis; campus about 13:00. Target 14:00-16:00 admission info + guided tour. Arboretum 16:00-17:00, dinner. [U11] **Google Maps:** Departure LAX | SMF > UC Davis	Davis town inn. **20:30-06:30**
D4 02 Feb Tue	**Sacramento > Chicago** 06:45 depart Davis, 45-60min to SMF; return rental. Target 09:30-15:30 ORD (4h flight + 2h time change). Bags and 60-90min to Evanston; dinner. **Google Maps:** Davis > SMF | ORD > Evanston	Evanston. **21:00-07:00**
D5 03 Feb Wed	**Northwestern > Notre Dame** Target Northwestern visit 09:30-11:30; alumni/lunch 12:00-13:00. Drive 14:00 CENTRAL > 18:00 EASTERN (3h + clock change). Check in and dinner. [U1] **Google Maps:** Northwestern > Notre Dame	Morris Inn. **21:00-07:00**
D6 04 Feb Thu	**Notre Dame > Ann Arbor** Target Notre Dame admissions visit 09:30-11:30. Lunch; drive 13:00-16:30 to Ann Arbor. Friend/family dinner 17:00-18:30. [U3] **Google Maps:** Drive to Michigan	Ann Arbor. **20:30-06:30**
D7 05 Feb Fri	**Michigan > Washington** Target Michigan tour/info 09:00-11:00; 11:00-12:00 pharmaceutical-sciences questions if staff available. Depart 13:00, DTW by 14:00, return car. Target flight 16:30-18:00 DCA; hotel about 19:00. [U4] **Google Maps:** Michigan > DTW | Arrival DCA	Washington. **21:00-07:00**
D8 06 Feb Sat	**Smithsonian > New York** 10:00 Air and Space entry; target 10:30 The Sky Tonight (first-Saturday pattern, reconfirm). Lunch and exhibits until 14:30. Union Station 15:45; target train 16:30-20:00 to NYC (3.5h). Hotel about 21:00. [A2] **Google Maps:** Museum > Union Station | Train: DC > NYC	NYC Midtown West. **21:30-07:30**

E | UC Davis biology + veterinary exploration

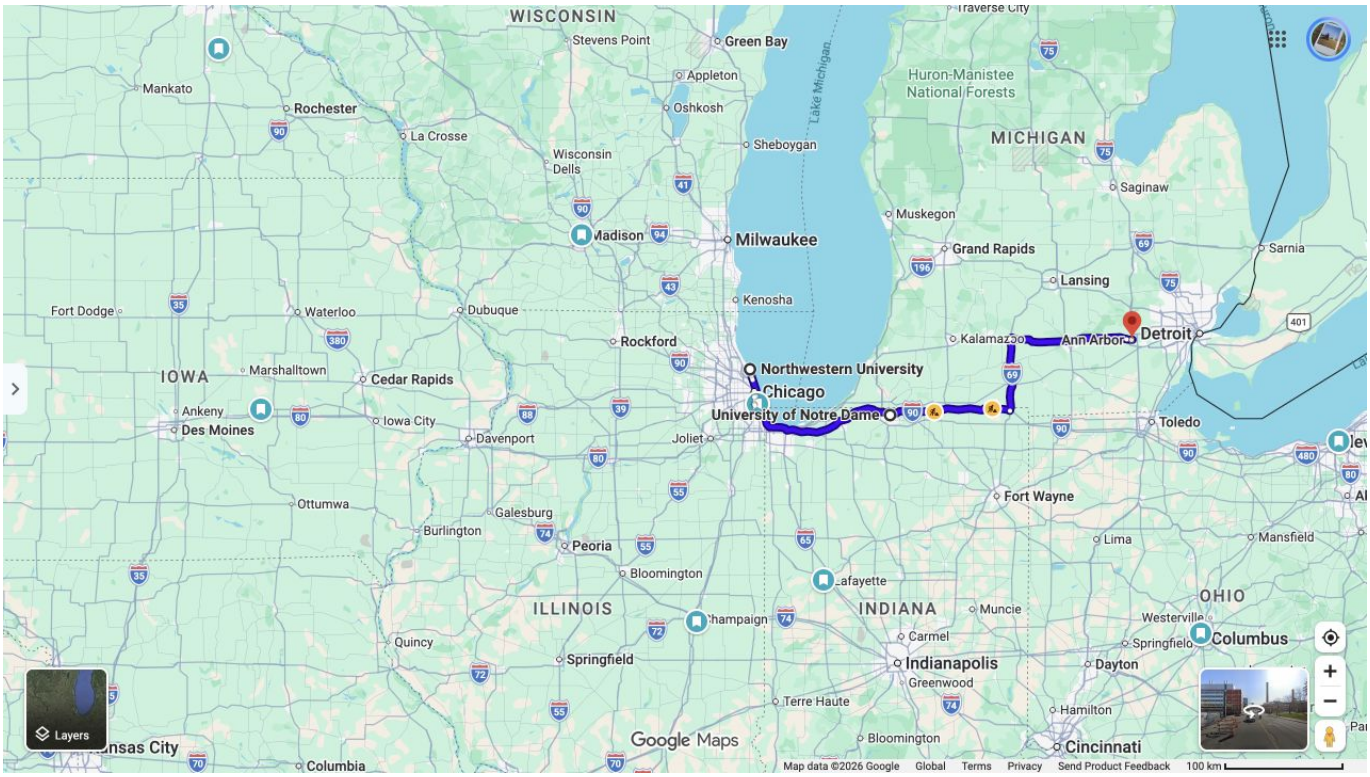
Best if animal science is a leading interest · Days 9-16 · Back to route map

Adds Davis and one domestic flight (3 total). Preserves all must-visits, but changes the preferred direct LA-Chicago leg. Less Chicago leisure and tighter Midwest appointments.

Day	Activities and transport (local time)	Stay / protected rest
D9 07 Feb Sun	**NYC full day 1: stars + stage** 10:00-12:00 AMNH / Hayden space show, ticket permitting. Lunch. Target Wicked matinee 14:00-16:45. Rockefeller Center, FAO/Jellycat and Nintendo 17:00-18:30; dinner 19:00. Walk/subway, 15-40min legs. [A3-A5] **Google Maps:** AMNH > Wicked | Wicked > FAO > Nintendo	NYC, second full sightseeing day follows. **21:30-07:30**
D10 08 Feb Mon	**NYC full day 2: city life** 09:30 Greenwich Village/NYU (official tour only if reserved); SoHo 11:00, Chinatown lunch 12:30. Wall Street/Bull 14:00; 9/11 Memorial 15:15; Flatiron 17:00; Empire State 18:00, dinner 19:00. Subway/walk 15-35min legs. **Google Maps:** Village > SoHo > Chinatown | Bull > memorial > Flatiron > Empire	NYC, third night. **20:30-06:30**
D11 09 Feb Tue	**NYC > Cornell** 07:00 car collection; depart 07:30. Allow 5.5h including breaks, arrive Ithaca 13:00. Lunch/parking. Target 14:00-16:00 Cornell registered tour/info. Cottage check-in about 17:00; dinner 18:00. [U5] **Google Maps:** Drive NYC > Cornell	Ithaca: New Park cottage candidate. **20:30-06:30**
D12 10 Feb Wed	**Cornell > Dartmouth** 07:00 depart; allow 6.5h including breaks, arrive Hanover 13:30. Target 14:15 check-in, 14:30-16:15 Dartmouth info/tour; alumni chat 16:30 if arranged. Packed lunch on road. This is the tightest tour/drive connection. [U6] **Google Maps:** Drive Cornell > Dartmouth	Hanover Inn. **21:00-07:00**
D13 11 Feb Thu	**Dartmouth > Amherst > Boston** 08:30 depart; drive 2h15 to Amherst. Target 11:30-13:30 registered Amherst visit. Lunch; 14:30 drive 2.5h to Boston. Return car, dinner 18:00. [U7] **Google Maps:** Dartmouth > Amherst > BU	Boston Back Bay. **21:00-07:00**
D14 12 Feb Fri	**Boston full day > airport** 09:30-11:30 Boston University tour/info. Chinatown lunch 12:30; Public Garden 14:00-15:00; Newbury Street shops 15:15-16:15. Hotel 17:00-20:00 for meal, packing and rest (keep room/day-use). Taxi 20:45; BOS 21:30. Harvard/MIT excluded unless both required appointments are confirmed. [U2] **Google Maps:** BU > Chinatown > Public Garden | Public Garden > Newbury > BOS	No hotel overnight: flight just after midnight. Protected 10h rest on long-haul flight.
D15 13 Feb Sat	**Boston > Hong Kong** Candidate CX811 departs BOS 00:30 SATURDAY 13 Feb; flight about 15h30. Arrive Hong Kong SUNDAY 14 Feb. Protect a 10h in-flight rest block after initial meal. [F2] **Google Maps:** BOS terminal location	In flight; **10h protected rest**.
D16 14 Feb Sun	**Home in Hong Kong** Candidate CX811 arrives 05:00 HKT, Sunday 14 Feb. Transfer home and leave the day unscheduled for sleep/recovery. Arrival meets Day 16 deadline. [F2] **Google Maps:** Hong Kong arrival	Hong Kong home; recovery day.

Actual Google Maps view: Midwest

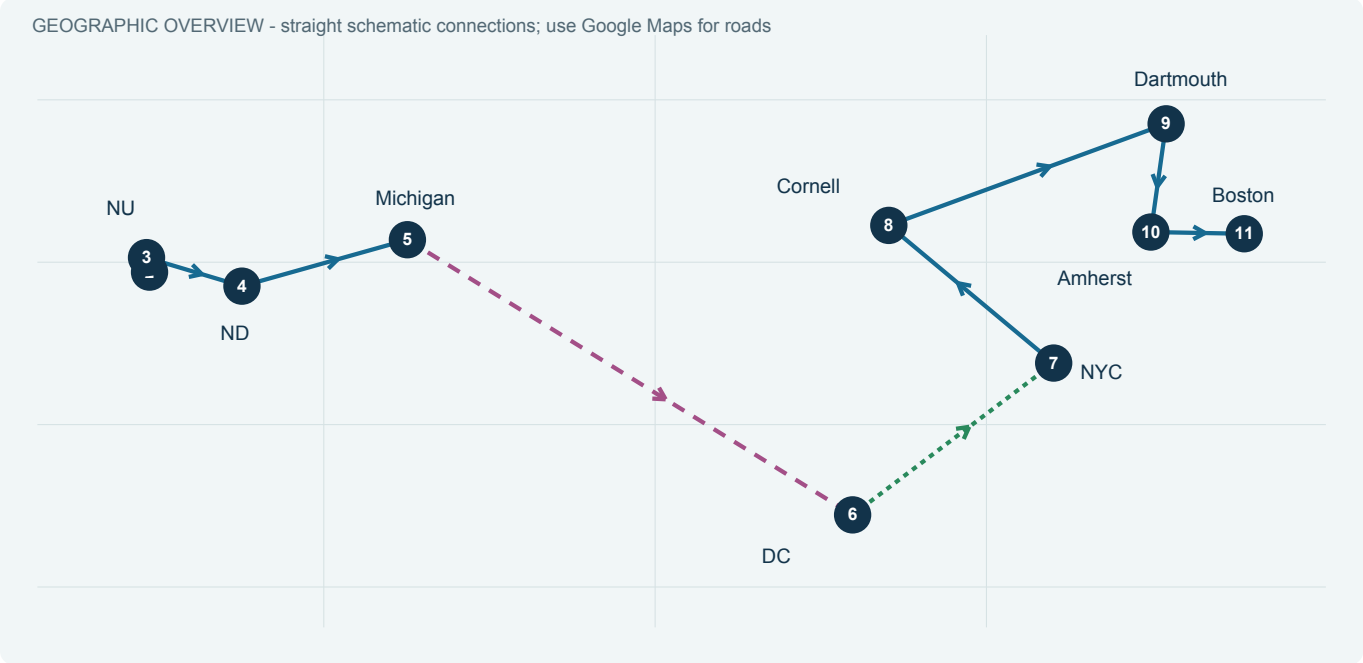
Captured from your signed-in Google Maps session on 23 October 2026. This is the common Northwestern-Notre Dame-Michigan driving sequence used in A/B/D/E. C visits Notre Dame and Michigan before returning to Northwestern; follow C's numbered map and daily navigation links for its different order.



The image retains Google attribution. Its blue road line represents this ground segment only, not flights elsewhere in the trip. Google's current routing and traffic times can change.

Enlarged eastern-route overview

Use the numbered regional Google Maps link on each route page to zoom, inspect roads or start navigation. The trip-wide maps are geographic diagrams, not Google basemap images. Additional live Google captures could not be completed after Google Maps lost internet access.



Transport: observed Maps times vs usable budgets

Directions checked live on 23 October 2026. Click a route to reopen Google Maps. Raw estimates are not winter forecasts. Planning budgets cover driving and normal breaks; add airport check-in/rental return separately. Avoid the Canada shortcut between Michigan and upstate New York.

Google Maps route	Observed estimate	Schedule allowance
Northwestern Univ. Evanston > Notre Dame	2h04 / 112mi	3-3.5h + 1h clock change
Notre Dame > Michigan Ann Arbor	2h47 / 176mi	3.5-4h
Michigan Ann Arbor > Cornell Univ.	7h46 / 495mi US route	9-10h; split via Cleveland
Times Square New York > Cornell Univ.	3h56 / 223mi	5-5.5h + car collection
Cornell Univ. > Dartmouth	5h25 / 297mi	6-6.5h; critical A/C/E leg
Dartmouth > Amherst	1h45 / 108mi	2h15-2h30
Amherst > Boston Univ.	1h39 / 88.9mi	2-2.5h
Dartmouth > Boston Univ.	2h04 / 127mi	2h45-3h
Michigan Ann Arbor > Case Western Reserve Univ.	2h47 / 169mi	3.5-4h
Case Western Reserve Univ. > Cornell Univ.	5h10 / 328mi	6-6.5h
Cornell Univ. > Williams	3h43 / 199mi	4.5-5h

Transport continued + flight date traps

Google Maps route	Observed estimate	Schedule allowance
Williams > Dartmouth	2h10 / 115mi	2h45-3h
Boston Univ. > Wellesley	21min / 13.1mi	45-60min each way
Los Angeles airport > Disneyland Park Anaheim	47min / 34.2mi	75-100min after immigration
Disneyland Park Anaheim > SpaceX Hawthorne	32min / 29.9mi	60-75min
SpaceX Hawthorne > UCLA	20min / 15.5mi	45-60min
UCLA > Santa Monica Pier	12min / 9.4mi	30-45min
Sacramento airport > UC Davis Welcome Center	26min / 23.9mi	45-60min + rental collection
Michigan Ann Arbor > Northwestern Univ. Evanston	4h12 / 255mi	5-5.5h; gain 1h CENTRAL
Michigan Ann Arbor > Detroit Metropolitan Airport	26min / 24.2mi	45-60min + rental return
Union Station Washington DC > Moynihan Train Hall NYC	Northeast Regional 3h21	3h15-3h45 rail; 4.5-5h door to door

International flight candidates, not confirmed reservations

Leg	Published winter pattern	Planning consequence
Outbound [F1]	UA821: Fri 29 Jan HKG 22:45 > LAX 19:30 same date; 12h45.	Late arrival. Disney starts 10:30 next day after 23:30-09:30 hotel rest.
A / C / E return [F2]	CX811: Sat 13 Feb BOS 00:30 > Sun 14 Feb HKG 05:00; 15h30.	Go to BOS on FRIDAY 12 Feb, 21:30. Keep Boston room through the evening.
B / D return [F3]	CX831: Sat 13 Feb JFK 13:40 > Sun 14 Feb HKG 18:55; 16h15.	Stay NYC Friday night; JFK by 10:30 Saturday. Less delay margin before deadline.

These are published timetable candidates checked during research, not airline seat availability or fares. Reconfirm exact dates with the operating airline. A schedule change can alter the whole return constraint. Do not assume a Friday-evening US departure arrives Saturday in Hong Kong.

Time zones in this trip: Hong Kong UTC+8; LA/Davis Pacific UTC-8; Chicago/Evanston Central UTC-6; Notre Dame, Ann Arbor and all eastern stops UTC-5. Notre Dame is on Eastern Time. Domestic flight planning includes roughly 2h at the departure airport, plus local transfers and bags/rental time.

Guided visits: reservation register

Request places for 2 adults + a 14-year-old prospective student. These are undergraduate exploratory visits for possible 2030 entry. University calendars, not this document, determine actual availability. Existing formats below were checked in October 2026.

School / planned dates	Current official format and booking route	Specific discussion goal
Northwestern A/B/D: 2 Feb C: 5 Feb; E: 3 Feb	Visit campus [U1] General tours 75-90min; journalism/arts/media route also listed. Medill academic session usually Friday 13:00, separately arranged.	Journalism + biology/econ double-major feasibility; writing load; campus-city balance; alumni conversation.
Notre Dame A/B/D: 3 Feb C: 2 Feb; E: 4 Feb	Admissions visit [U3] Admissions presentation + student tour. A public historic campus tour is a different product.	Community, faith and non-Catholic experience; biology/econ advising; undergraduate research.
Michigan A/B/D: 4 Feb C: 3 Feb; E: 5 Feb	Campus visit [U4] Registered 75min outdoor tour; info sessions except Saturdays. No walk-ins. Family of 3 fits stated party limit of 4.	Large-campus advising, class size, biology/econ and BS Pharmaceutical Sciences routes; ask friend about real daily life.
Cornell A/C/E: 9 Feb B: 6 Feb (or 5 Feb) D: 8 Feb	Visit and connect [U5] Register tour and relevant college information session separately as needed. Visit does not confer demonstrated-interest advantage.	CALS Animal Science vs biological sciences / Arts & Sciences; pre-vet prerequisites; access for international students.
Dartmouth A/C/E: 10 Feb B: 8 Feb; D: 10 Feb	Winter visits [U6] Published winter format: 30min staff info + 75min student tour. This is not confirmation of February 2027 slots.	Small-town winter life, biology/econ flexibility, research, writing opportunities; meet school alum if arranged.
Boston University A/C/E: 12 Feb B: 9 Feb; D: 11 Feb	Visit BU [U2] Book tour/information session through admissions calendar. Correct institution: Boston University, not Boston College.	BMB BA curriculum, lab entry, maths/physics demands, biotechnology careers; clarify that BA is not PharmD.

Guided visits: liberal arts + additions

Campus / dates	Visit format and link	Why it earns the detour
Amherst A/C/E: 11 Feb	Register [U7] Request guided tour and info session together.	One small-college comparator without adding another overnight city.
Wellesley B: 9 Feb; D: 11 Feb	Campus visits [U9] Current format: 30min counselor info + 75min student tour.	Women's-college experience, science/econ, faculty access, Boston proximity.
Williams D: 9 Feb	Visit Williams [U8] Current format: 1h tour + 1h information session.	Rural residential LAC compared with Wellesley and urban BU. Spring term starts 3 Feb; 4 Feb is no-class day. [C1]
Case Western B: 5 Feb, optional	Visit CWRU [U10] Official tour/info if available.	Makes the Cleveland overnight educational. Drop before sacrificing a required school.
UC Davis E: 1 Feb	Campus tour [U11] Current format: 30min info + 90min student tour.	Animal science and biology. Request undergraduate perspective; animal facilities/clinical visits need separate permission.

How to secure a useful conversation

Reserve official information sessions and student-led tours first. Ask the admissions office whether a short counselor Q&A; or designated student ambassador conversation can be added. A private admissions-officer meeting is not guaranteed. Arrange alumni/friend meetings separately; they complement but do not replace official admissions advice. Contact each school 4-6 weeks ahead, sooner when calendars open; do not send a generic demand for an admissions assessment.

Ask these six questions at each core school

1. Which undergraduate routes best combine biology, economics and writing, and how hard is switching?
2. When can a first-year student join a lab or do fieldwork, and what do they actually do?
3. What maths, chemistry and writing courses are required even for students who dislike them?
4. What academic preparation and sustained interests does the office value, without predicting Olivia's chances?
5. How do international students receive advising, academic support and access to research or animal-related experience?
6. What does a normal winter week look like: housing, food, workload, social life and access to a city?

After each visit, Olivia should privately rate three things: "I can imagine living here"; "I want to study this subject here"; "I understood how to get help". Each person writes one appealing feature and one concern. This makes the trip a comparison exercise, not a race to collect university names.

Family experiences that fit the route

Experience	Plan and why it fits	Reservation / access limits
Wicked on Broadway	Best first choice: famous musical, strong visual storytelling, and a clear link to Ariana Grande's film role as Glinda. Running time 2h45 including interval. Explain the plot in Chinese beforehand. [A4]	Ariana is NOT promised in the Broadway cast. Matinee times are provisional. The Lion King is a more visually immediate alternative if language is a concern; choose one show.
Smithsonian stars + flight	A/C/E target Sat 6 Feb, first Saturday, for the current 10:30 Sky Tonight pattern. All options visit the Washington Air and Space Museum. Spacecraft, aviation and a short planetarium show make this an achievement-focused museum stop. [A2]	Free museum-entry reservation and planetarium arrangements are separate. Most daily shows are paid; current show titles/schedule must be rechecked. No guarantee of observatory access.
NYC teenager city day	AMNH's current space show Encounters in the Milky Way; FAO Schwarz/Jellycat Diner, Nintendo NY, SoHo fashion/beauty browsing. Choose stores Olivia likes; her dislike of CS says nothing about whether she likes games. [A3,A5]	Jellycat experience may require reservations; check stock and timings. No Ariana concert, r.e.m. pop-up or artist appearance is assumed.
Saved NYC landmarks	Include Empire State, Flatiron exterior, Charging Bull, and 9/11 Memorial. For the saved 9/11 Museum itself, replace the optional NYU/SoHo morning with a 2h museum visit; discuss the sensitive subject beforehand.	Empire State requires timed tickets. Memorial exterior is the default because two museums in a day could overwhelm the family. Do not quietly count exterior as museum admission.
Businesses and US achievements	SpaceX exterior; Disney's entertainment/business model; NYSE/Wall Street facades; Rockefeller Center/NBC surroundings. Ask Olivia how science, finance, media and business connect. Boston leisure uses Public Garden/Newbury Street instead of a casual Harvard/MIT-area visit.	These are public-area observations, not corporate office/factory/lab tours. SpaceX photo from legal public sidewalk only. [A7]
Nature in short winter blocks	Santa Monica beach; Notre Dame campus/Grotto; Cornell lake scenery; Hanover town/campus; Wellesley or Williams setting. Warm up between 30-60min outdoor blocks.	Use maintained paths and daylight. Do not plan icy gorge trails or remote cabin access as essential activities. Weather can replace a walk with a café/campus indoor stop.

Stays and food: comfortable, distinctive, practical

These are property candidates, not availability or price quotes. Confirm a room/cottage legally sleeps three, heating, bathroom arrangements, parking, snow clearance, cancellation and minimum stays. A small historic campus inn is often more practical in February than a remote cabin.

Place	Suggested stay / character	Practical use
Anaheim / LA	Walkable Disneyland hotel for 29-30 Jan; LAX airport hotel 31 Jan.	Walking after Disney protects rest. Switching to LAX reduces Monday traffic exposure.
Evanston	Graduate Evanston - university character, close to Northwestern.	Avoid downtown Chicago hotel if morning campus visit is the priority.
Notre Dame	Morris Inn - distinctive on-campus hotel.	Makes the campus environment part of the overnight stay.
Ann Arbor	Graduate Ann Arbor or central campus-area hotel.	Walkable food and easy friend meeting; confirm triple occupancy.
Ithaca	New Park Event Venue & Suites - cottage/suite setting with individual character.	Best cabin-like candidate. Confirm winter operation and family unit. Some suites have a kitchenette, not full kitchen. Allow extra transfer time; exact property route not Maps-checked.
Hanover / Williamstown	Hanover Inn; The Williams Inn.	Distinctive town/campus stays with easier winter access. Williams overnight belongs to D.
Amherst	Inn on Boltwood if a rearranged route needs an overnight.	Current schedules stop here without an overnight.
NYC / Boston / DC	NYC Midtown West; Boston Back Bay; Washington near Mall/Union Station.	Prioritize walkability and two real beds. Keep Boston room until evening on A/C/E return day.

A food rhythm that works for the whole family

Plan one warm Chinese-style meal every day: rice/noodles, soup, vegetables and familiar proteins. Use hotel breakfast or kitchenette food before long drives. Keep American tastings small and optional: New York bagel/pizza, a burger, or Boston seafood. Winter is a poor time to rely on long outdoor queues.

Xi'an Famous Foods, NYC offers noodles and burgers; Chinatown adds buns, roast meats and noodle shops. Dumpling Cafe, Boston offers a familiar Chinese menu. QXY Dumplings, Chicago is a dumpling option if downtown/Chinatown fits, not a required detour. Santa Monica Din Tai Fung is an optional more expensive familiar meal. In smaller towns, check open Chinese restaurants near the actual inn and order early.

Planning allowances only: quick meals roughly US$15-25 per adult, casual sit-down US$25-45, before tax/tips; not live menu quotes or a trip budget. Hotel/flight prices and room inventory have not been checked.

Winter resilience and booking sequence

A practical definition of “10 hours of rest”

The hotel windows in each row are protected, unscheduled room time. They exclude dinner, packing, late drives and sightseeing. Allow ordinary washing/settling within that block; if you mean 10 hours of actual sleep, extend the windows by another hour and remove optional sights. Long-haul flights use the in-flight rest exception you approved. A delayed Broadway finish must move the next morning later.

Where a disruption would matter most

A/C/E: Cornell-Tuesday to Dartmouth-Wednesday is the key link: 6-6.5h winter road allowance before an afternoon tour. Secure that afternoon slot first. If forecast snow threatens it, leave Ithaca after the Cornell visit for an intermediate overnight, sacrificing the cottage; this requires a fresh route/timing check. If roads are unsafe, the fixed 16-day plan may require removing an optional activity or revising the tour date. No itinerary can guarantee every appointment during a storm.

B: the US-only Ann Arbor-Cornell road journey is roughly 9-10h with breaks, split via Cleveland. This is worthwhile for Case Western and a road trip, not a magical time saver. The Saturday Cornell booking is the deciding condition; drop Case and use Friday Cornell if needed.

C: protect the Friday Medill session and allow a late flight to Washington; don’t book an early ORD departure that cuts it short. **D:** Boston-flight-Smithsonian-train on the final Friday is a concentrated travel day; delay can reduce museum time. **E:** confirm both Davis’s Monday afternoon tour and Michigan’s Friday morning tour before adding Sacramento flights.

Booking order

1. Select a route and check all core campus calendars as soon as February visits open; hold realistic tour windows.
2. Confirm HKG-LAX and BOS-HKG or JFK-HKG dates, baggage and family seating directly with airlines.
3. Lock domestic flights/Amtrak around the confirmed tours, with changeable fares where practical.
4. Reserve refundable hotels/cottages and a suitable rental car, including one-way drop fees and winter equipment policy. Keep all road routes in the US.
5. Buy Disney admission plus park reservation; then Broadway, Smithsonian entry/planetarium and NYC timed attractions.
6. Arrange friend/alumni conversations and send the short school-specific questions; none have been sent for you.
7. Recheck weather, road conditions and campus closures 7 days and 48 hours before each driving segment.

Rental outlines: A/B/D/C use Chicago-area collection through DTW except C returns in Chicago and B continues to Boston. A/C/E collect again in NYC and return Boston. D collects NYC and returns Boston. E also needs a brief SMF-Davis rental. Prefer transit/taxis in Manhattan and Boston; do not keep a car simply to park it.

給太太的中文重點

日期是 2027 年 1 月 29 日晚上由香港出發，2 月 14 日或之前抵港。建議先考慮 A 線：洛杉磯、芝加哥、西北大學、聖母大學、密歇根大學、華盛頓、紐約、康奈爾、達特茅斯、阿默斯特學院、波士頓。這是內容豐富的考察旅行，並不是輕鬆度假。

每條路線都有兩天洛杉磯地區活動，其中一天完整留給迪士尼；紐約至少有兩個完整遊玩日及住宿；波士頓至少一天。平常晚上預留最少十小時在房間休息，兩程長途飛機則按你們同意的方式預留機上休息。

Olivia 目前最值得深入了解的是生物及經濟。她的數學成績其實不差，不喜歡數學與學不來是兩回事。生物化學、經濟和獸醫升學都仍然需要一定的數學、統計及化學。新聞學可以先了解科學或商業報道，並不等同辯論比賽。

參觀大學時，不必只問排名或能否錄取。更重要的是：老師是否容易接觸？新生能否進實驗室？轉專業是否方便？每天功課有多少？冬天的生活、宿舍、飲食、朋友和支援如何？讓女兒自己說出喜歡及擔心的地方。

A 線最平衡；B 線適合長途自駕並順路看凱斯西儲大學；C 線為了星期五 Medill 新聞學活動而繞回芝加哥；D 線比較威廉姆斯及韋爾斯利；E 線多去戴維斯了解動物科學。哈佛、耶魯、麻省理工只在確認官方校園導賞及招生官會面後才加入，現在不安排順道參觀。

百老匯首選《Wicked》，因為故事著名，也和 Ariana Grande 的電影角色有聯繫；但不代表她本人會在百老匯演出。可先用中文了解劇情。如果想選更容易憑視覺欣賞的作品，可改看《獅子王》。

華盛頓的史密森尼航空航天博物館可以看飛機、航天器及天象節目。A、C、E 線安排 2 月 6 日，暫按每月首個星期六上午的星空節目規律規劃，仍須確認。這是天文，不是占星。洛杉磯 SpaceX 只安排公共地方拍照，不是廠房參觀。

飲食每天預留一餐熟悉的熱食，例如米飯、湯麵、餃子和蔬菜，不必每餐都昂貴。小鎮住宿可選有特色的校園旅館；伊薩卡可考慮有暖氣的小屋，但須確認冬季營業、三人入住及除雪安排。遇到下雪，先刪除購物或額外景點，不壓縮休息。

A、C、E 線返港航班候選是 2 月 13 日凌晨 00:30 從波士頓起飛，因此 2 月 12 日星期五晚上就要到機場，預計 2 月 14 日早上抵港。B、D 線候選為 2 月 13 日下午從紐約出發，14 日晚上抵港。所有航班和住宿均未預訂。

Sources and reservation links

Research checked 23 October 2026. These links support current formats and planning assumptions, not availability on future travel dates. Google Maps evidence is documented in the route tables and saved-list notes. Academic evidence is identified on the profile page.

R1 2027 ranking tables (secondary compilation)

R2 BU confirms national rank 34

R3 UC Davis ranking announcement

U1 Northwestern campus visits / Medill sessions

U2 Boston University visits and booking

U3 Notre Dame admissions visits

U4 Michigan campus visit registration

U5 Cornell visits and connections

U6 Dartmouth winter visit formats

U7 Amherst campus visits

U8 Williams campus visits

U9 Wellesley visits

U10 Case Western visits

U11 UC Davis tour information

U12 Tufts campus locations and visits

U13 Harvard College official visits; admissions vs historical tours

U14 Yale campus tours and officer-led admissions sessions

U15 MIT official in-person sessions and tours

P1 BU Biochemistry and Molecular Biology BA requirements

P2 Medill double-major opportunities

P3 Michigan BS Pharmaceutical Sciences

P4 Cornell pre-professional preparation

P5 UC Davis Animal Science major

Accommodation and food sources are linked directly on their planning page. All links are for verification or reservation by you; opening this pack makes no bookings.

Sources continued

C1 Williams 2026-27 academic calendar

C2 BU semester calendar

C3 Cornell academic calendar (February break begins 13 Feb)

F1 UA821 published schedule - HKG/LAX sector (third-party timetable)

F2 CX811 published schedule (third-party timetable)

F2a Cathay Boston-Hong Kong route

F3 CX831 published schedule (third-party timetable)

A1 Disneyland tickets / park reservations

A2 Smithsonian planetarium programs / Sky Tonight

A2a Smithsonian theaters and planetarium

A3 AMNH space-show page (redirects to current show)

A4 Wicked official FAQ / duration

A5 FAO Schwarz in-store experiences

A5a Nintendo New York official store

A5b Jellycat Diner NYC

A7 SpaceX official launches / Starbase headquarters identification

A7a SpaceX Falcon guide: Hawthorne production facility

A7b Hawthorne exterior photo location (local visitor guide)

A8 NFL 2026-27 important dates

A8a SoFi Stadium Super Bowl LXI

H1 Hong Kong 2027 general holidays